Zhifan Zhou

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University Pittsburgh, PA
B.S. in Information Systems; additional major in Artificial Intelligence *Aug. 2025 - Present*

- **Expected Graduation:** June 2029
- **Honors:** Dean's List, 2026
- **Selected Coursework:** Fundamentals of Programming & Computer Science, Concepts of Mathematics, Matrices and Linear Transformations, Concepts in Artificial Intelligence

PUBLICATIONS

RSI-Master: Structuring Experiments to Guide Autonomous Model Improvement

arXiv Preprint | arXiv: 2609.35561 | GitHub: RSI-Master

- Co-authored a framework for autonomous model improvement combining an Experiment OS with reviewer-guided research orchestration over a dynamic research DAG.
- The system achieved a 54.49 average on PostTrainBench versus 46.53 for the strongest agent baseline, with a 0.0% observed hacking rate.

DataMaster: Data-Centric Autonomous AI Research | *arXiv Preprint*

arXiv: 2605.10906 | GitHub: DataMaster

- Developed an autonomous framework for discovering, selecting, and cleaning external data to improve downstream machine learning and post-training performance.
- Designed a tree-structured search architecture with a shared data pool, enabling exploration of open-ended data spaces while preserving global memory across branches.
- Increased the MLE-Bench Lite medal rate by 32.27% and outperformed the instruct baseline on PostTrainBench GPQA by 0.67 percentage points.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Research Intern May 2026 - Present
NLP Lab, Eastern Institute of Technology *Ningbo, China*

- Develop a streaming omni model for real-time multimodal interaction using a full-duplex training paradigm, under the supervision of Prof. Xiaoyu Shen.
- Develop post-training data pipelines by curating omni-modal conversational datasets, aligning cross-modal signals, and defining fine-grained timestamp annotations for precise temporal supervision.

Research Intern Feb. 2026 - Present
MAGIC Lab, Shanghai Jiao Tong University *Shanghai, China*

- Conduct research on self-evolving agents and AI-for-science systems under Prof. Siheng Chen.
- Contribute to projects spanning multi-agent governance, autonomous AI systems, and scientific discovery workflows.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, Java, C

Libraries & Frameworks: PyTorch, NumPy, pandas, Matplotlib

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (Native), English (Professional Working Proficiency)

Interests: Basketball, Table Tennis, Badminton, Tennis, Go (1 dan), Taekwondo (Red-Black Belt)